

— A FREE GUIDE · @OLLIERDZ

How to get started with

Claude Skills

Teach Claude to do your repeat tasks **your way** — once. Build your first skill in 5 minutes, then steal three you can use today.

```
my-skill/
```

— SKILL.md	← the instructions Claude reads
— scripts/	← optional code it can run
— assets/	← fonts, templates, data

— THE IDEA

What a skill actually is

A skill is a **folder that teaches Claude a job**. At its core is one file — **SKILL.md** — written mostly in plain English. You can also bundle scripts, templates, fonts, or data the task needs.

The magic is **progressive disclosure**: Claude only sees each skill's name and description until your request actually needs it — then it loads the full instructions and files. That means you can keep dozens of skills without slowing Claude down.

Skill vs. a saved prompt

A saved prompt is just text you paste. A skill is **reusable expertise** Claude loads on its own — and it can carry real tools (code, fonts, API flows), not just words.

"Explain it once. Use it forever."

— DO IT NOW

Your first skill in 5 minutes

Create a folder, add one file, and paste this in. The **description** line is the most important part — it's how Claude decides when to use the skill.

```
my-skill/SKILL.md
---
name: linkedin-rewriter
description: Rewrites rough notes into a punchy LinkedIn
  post in my voice. Use when I paste notes and ask for
  a LinkedIn post.
---

# What this does
Turn my messy notes into one scroll-stopping post.

## Rules
- Hook in the first line. No "I'm excited to announce".
- Short lines. One idea per line.
- End with a question to drive comments.
```

That's a working skill. Drop it where Claude can see it (next page), then just say: *"here are my notes – make a LinkedIn post."*

— STEAL THESE

3 skills to use today

Copy the description into a new SKILL.md, tweak the rules to your brand, done.

1

carousel-maker

Description: Builds an on-brand Instagram carousel (cover + slides) from a topic. Use when I ask for a carousel or slides.

2

thumbnail-maker

Description: Generates high-CTR YouTube thumbnail concepts and copy. Use when I mention a thumbnail or video title.

3

content-repurposer

Description: Turns one long video or post into 5 short-form hooks across platforms. Use when I paste a transcript or ask to repurpose.

Tip: keep each skill narrow. One job, one folder. Narrow skills trigger more reliably than a giant do-everything one.

Where to install

Claude Code

Put the folder in one of these:

```
.claude/skills/my-skill/SKILL.md  # this project  
~/.claude/skills/my-skill/SKILL.md  # every project
```

Claude detects it automatically — no restart, no config.

claude.ai

Add it under **Settings → Capabilities → Skills**. Anthropic also ships official skills (canvas-design, pdf, pptx, xlsx) at

github.com/anthropics/skills — a great place to learn the format.

Want the full system?

Follow **@ollierdz** for the carousels, prompts, and skills I use to run all of this on autopilot.